Reading and writing

2026-10-26 | Week 3 | Characters take action

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8C

3.8C: Analyze plot elements, including the sequence of events, the conflict, and the resolution. In plain English: Explain the order of story events, the problem and how it is solved. Today: Identify the problem: the pumpkin will not come free.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.8C

4.8C: Analyze plot elements, including the rising action, climax, falling action, and resolution. In plain English: Explain how a story builds to its turning point and moves toward a solution. Today: Explain why the characters' separate attempts do not solve the problem.

I Do

Grade 3: Open Big Pumpkin to the matching scene. Say, "We are learning to identify the problem: the pumpkin will not come free." Use small pumpkin, character figures, ribbon for a pretend vine to model one response, then point to the page that supports it. Grade 4: Open Big Pumpkin to the matching scene. Say, "We are learning to explain why the characters' separate attempts do not solve the problem." Use small pumpkin, character figures, ribbon for a pretend vine to model one response, then point to the page that supports it.

We Do

Read the scene aloud again. Each learner moves the character props to show the problem, action and result. Ask the Grade 3 learner to retell the events; ask the Grade 4 learner why the action matters. Fade the model; return to the real illustrations before accepting an answer.

You Do

Grade 3: Identify the problem: the pumpkin will not come free. Grade 4: Explain why the characters' separate attempts do not solve the problem. Use one fresh question from a familiar page. Record the response, page/scene and help used.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Match familiar props or photos from the already taught scene, sequence two mastered event photos, or use a known Vizzle task. Independent reading is not assumed.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Real books: Big Pumpkin. Bring the props and response mats in the weekly book guide.

Writing TEKS 3.7B

Write a response to a literary or informational text that demonstrates an understanding of a text.

Writing TEKS 4.7B

Write responses that demonstrate understanding of texts, including comparing and contrasting ideas across a variety of sources.

Writing and spelling

After the read-aloud, build one sentence from the evidence: Grade 3 retells an event; Grade 4 explains a character's action with a because statement. Keep HMH phonics/spelling at the assessed pattern; teach three words before Friday's spelling check. Writing TEKS 3.7B / 4.7B: compose a response to the actual text. Dictation or AAC composition is an access option; record the response method. Matching a picture alone is reading evidence, not independent written composition. For Grade 4, add an alike/different sentence comparing an idea in today's book with a previously read book; point to evidence in both sources.

8-9 AM read-aloud

Big Pumpkin by Erica Silverman. Return to the real pages for evidence; see the weekly book guide.

Math

2026-10-26 | Week 3 | Characters take action

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.4H, 3.4J

3.4H: Determine the number of objects in each group when a set of objects is partitioned into equal shares or a set of objects is shared equally. In plain English: Find how many objects are in each group after sharing equally. 3.4J: Determine a quotient using the relationship between multiplication and division. In plain English: Use a related multiplication fact to solve a division problem. Today: Share 6 counters between 2 plates, then show how many are in each group.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.5A

4.5A: Represent multi-step problems involving the four operations with whole numbers using strip diagrams and equations with a letter standing for the unknown quantity. In plain English: Represent multi-step problems using the four operations, diagrams and equations with a letter for the unknown. Today: Model 3 bags of 2 pencils, then give away 2. Choose operations and show 4 left; use n for the unknown when ready.

I Do

Grade 3: Share 8 counters between 2 plates; each plate receives 4. Connect the model to 8 / 2 = 4. Grade 4: Act out 2 bags with 3 pencils each, then give away 1 pencil. Build a strip diagram; connect it to (2 x 3) - 1 = n. Find 5 pencils left. Begin with one step if needed.

We Do

Both students handle the shared materials. Practice one example with the teacher; then teach the two targets in separate rotations. Grade 3: after sharing 8 into 2 equal groups, use 2 x 4 = 8 to explain why 8 / 2 = 4.

You Do

Grade 3: Share 6 counters between 2 plates, then show how many are in each group. Grade 4: Model 3 bags of 2 pencils, then give away 2. Choose operations and show 4 left; use n for the unknown when ready.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Complete a mastered counting/sorting tray or known Bridges practice task at the student's established level.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Counters, plates/cups and the linked math mat. Select the matching grade-level STEMscopes lesson. Use Bridges placement to choose a separate foundational intervention.

Science

2026-10-26 | Week 3 | Characters take action

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8A

3.8A: Identify everyday examples of energy, including light, sound, thermal, and mechanical. In plain English: Recognize everyday examples of light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. Today: Identify light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.8A, 4.8B, 4.8C

4.8A: Investigate and identify the transfer of energy by objects in motion, waves in water, and sound. In plain English: Investigate how moving objects, water waves and sound transfer energy. 4.8B: Identify conductors and insulators of thermal and electrical energy. In plain English: Identify materials that let heat or electricity pass through and materials that resist it. 4.8C: Demonstrate and describe how electrical energy travels in a closed path that can produce light and thermal energy. In plain English: Show that electricity travels around a closed path and can produce light and heat. Today: Observe energy transfer, test materials and build a closed circuit.

I Do

Grade 3: Show a flashlight, shaker, safely lukewarm sealed bottle and moving car. Name light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. Grade 4: Use moving cars, sound, thermal conductors and a low-voltage battery circuit to observe transfer. Close the path to light a bulb; open it to stop.

We Do

Predict with objects or pictures, test together, then identify what changed. Keep one test variable different and other relevant conditions the same.

You Do

Grade 3: Match an object to its energy form; demonstrate one observable change. Grade 4: Show a transfer or closed circuit and identify what changed.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Sort familiar object/photo matches away from the experiment station. Experiments are adult supervised.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Two puppets or figures, counters, square tiles, flashlight, shaker, battery circuit kit. Adult manages circuit parts, magnets, small items and warm materials; use a low-voltage kit only.

Social studies

2026-10-26 | Week 3 | Characters take action

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.9A

3.9A: Identify characteristics of good citizenship, including truthfulness, justice, equality, respect for oneself and others, responsibility in daily life, and participation in government by educating oneself about the issues, respectfully holding public officials to their word, and voting. In plain English: Recognize responsible citizenship, including honesty, fairness, respect and participation in government. Today: Name a responsible action.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.2A

4.2A: Summarize motivations for European exploration and settlement of Texas, including economic opportunity, competition, and the desire for expansion. In plain English: Explain why Europeans explored and settled Texas, including opportunity, competition and expansion. Today: Show why Europeans explored Texas.

I Do

Grade 3: Name a responsible action. Model with one district source, naming the visible clue. Grade 4: Show why Europeans explored Texas. Use the current Texas history map, image or excerpt; name the person/event and point to the evidence.

We Do

Work together with a second example from the same source set. Use one large visual and one guiding question. Keep the grade-specific question visible and fade added hints.

You Do

Grade 3: Name a responsible action. Grade 4: Show why Europeans explored Texas. Use a fresh source/card; accept a model, pointing, AAC or a spoken explanation.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Match two familiar source pictures or complete a known picture-to-object task.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

District source pictures or excerpts, two-event sequence mat and writing/history frames. The classroom texts do not replace Texas history sources.